



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Saint Theresa Catholic School

School Website: <https://sttheresacatholicschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Saint Theresa Catholic School (STCS) presents itself as a clearly classical Catholic school that foregrounds the liberal arts and the Catholic intellectual tradition. Public materials describe a mission framed by a Catholic, classical vision, including explicit reference to the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Latin study, classical literature, liturgical life, and a goal of forming virtuous, capable students. The site also emphasizes Catholic identity through theology, weekly Mass, parish connections, and liturgical practices, alongside a family-centered community with active parental involvement.

Overall, STCS aligns most strongly with the Classical framework across the six categories, with especially robust signals in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, and School Purpose/Goal, plus strong signals in Parents & Community. Pedagogy and Faculty show substantial classical alignment but with comparatively less explicit articulation of every classical pedagogical element on public-facing pages; nonetheless, the cumulative evidence supports CLASSICAL across most dimensions. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

- Executive takeaway: The school's public materials map very closely to classical Catholic education norms (Catholic identity, liberal arts, Trivium, Great Books orientation through listed classics, contemplative memory work, and a strong parental partnership). The strongest opportunities to strengthen the rubric would be to make explicit the upper-school Socratic/seminar pedagogy and to foreground a few additional living-curriculum statements about the faculty as the living curriculum, even if such language exists in internal materials.
- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases only): Not applicable here since the aggregate is CLASSICAL. If desired, minor enhancements could include explicit language about Socratic seminars in upper grades and a stronger articulation of faculty as the living curriculum in public-facing materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence shows explicit Catholic identity, liturgical life, and theological grounding. Positive keyword indicators present (Catholic identity, theology, liturgy, Mass, weekly worship, virtue, imago Dei, sacred music). Negative indicators (relativism, secular humanism) are not evidenced on public pages. Why this rating: The mission and religious life are central to STCS public materials, with language about Catholic tradition, sacred liturgy, and formation of virtue.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the real-knowable true/good/beautiful; formation and liberal education framed as purposes beyond job-prep. Positive keywords (formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé/contemplation). Negative signals not evidenced on site. Why this rating: The public materials foreground formation of character and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty rather than a narrow workforce-preparation focus.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence highlights the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, classical literature, and a broad liberal-arts approach; references to studying the best ideas of the centuries and to Western civilization through music, art, and architecture of the medieval/renaissance periods; presence of classics and "Great Books"-style reading appears in

practice (e.g., sample classics across grades). Positive keywords (Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; classical literature; great books/classics; Western civilization; history via period study; music/the arts as part of a historical continuum). Negative indicators (project-based learning dominance, social-studies-terminology replacing history) not present in public content. Why this rating: Strong alignment with liberal-arts core, classical literature and languages, and an emphasis on historical/cultural study.

- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence shows a blend of contemplative/restful elements and memory-based pedagogy (chanting, singing, narration, recitation) and, in practice, discussion and reading of classics; upper grades show potential for more Socratic/seminar-style work, consistent with a K–8 classical model. Positive keywords (narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, scholé, contemplation, wonder, seminar-like discussion; rhetoric exercises). Negative indicators (heavy emphasis on experiential/project-based learning) are not clearly evidenced on public-facing pages. Why this rating: The site demonstrates key classical-pedagogy signals (memory, recitation, chanting, contemplation) and a pathway toward more advanced discourse, even if explicit Socratic seminars aren't loudly advertised on public pages.
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence of faculty presence exists (Headmaster welcome, faculty/staff pages, accreditation, and teacher leadership). Public materials do not consistently foreground the "living curriculum" language or a fully developed faculty portrait as central to daily pedagogy, though references to teachers, staff, and leadership appear. Positive keywords (faculty and staff presence; leadership; teachers as mentors). Negative signals (lack of explicit "living curriculum" portrait or faculty-led classical formation language) are not evident in public pages, but the strongest living-curriculum framing is not always explicit. Why this rating: There are clear signs of a serious, dedicated faculty, but the strongest classical-language framing (living curriculum, faculty as exemplars) is not consistently explicit in public-facing content.
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence shows active parental partnership and a dedicated parents' organization, with clear channels for parent involvement and formation. Positive keywords (partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, book clubs, open campus, hospitality, family liturgy, family participation). Negative indicators not evident in public content. Why this rating: The school emphasizes parent partnership and formation, aligning well with the classical model's emphasis on a close parent-school partnership.

What Would Move the Needle - Not necessary given CLASSICAL rating. If desired for further strengthening toward a fully explicit, fully robust classical framework, the school could: - Explicitly articulate upper-grade Socratic/seminar pedagogy on public materials (e.g., classroom routines, seminar formats, and assessment aligned with dialectic inquiry). - Expand language about the faculty as the living curriculum and provide public examples of faculty-led classical seminars or teacher-led Socratic discussions in practice. - More consistently foreground Great Books language and explicit mention of a "Great Conversation" framework on the site to reinforce the Classical identity.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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